BATTLETECH

OUTWORLDS WASTES

Casual BattleTech Event Framework

BATTLETECH: OUTWORLDS WASTES

BattleTech: Outworlds Wastes is a casual BattleTech league framework with simplified logistics rules. Players take the role of commander leading a combined arms force searching the Outworlds Wastes for lost technology and glory. Completing objectives in scenarios will earn C-bills that commanders can use to upgrade their forces. Different formats of scenario play are supported, to include BattleTech and BattleTech: Alpha Strike.

GOALS

- Have lots of fun while fostering a friendly and welcoming environment.
- Give players an opportunity to build personalized lore for their own BattleTech forces.
- Provide a lightweight framework for players to track the accomplishments of their forces.
- Explore BattleTech lore and equipment.
- Require minimal resources beyond *BattleTech: Total Warfare* and the *Master Unit List*.
- Support players across a variety of experience levels.

CONTENTS

These rules cover four general areas: background information, player information, event organizer information, and reference material. The background information describes the Outworlds Wastes region and the overall design of the Outworlds Wastes league. Force Construction rules and Force Maintenance and Improvements rules are the minimum rules needed for a player to jump into Outworlds Wastes league play. Scoring rules are provided for event organizers. The remaining content is reference material, to include a region map and list of references.

DISCLAIMER

This rule system is fan-made and based upon official BattleTech rules from Catalyst Game Labs. This system only adds simplified campaign logistics and force management rules along with sample scenarios and scoring. See the References for a list of official Catalyst Game Labs products that *BattleTech: Outworlds Wastes* specifically references.

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

BattleTech: Outworlds Wastes would not have been possible without hours of discussion, questions, and editing on the Colorado BattleTech Discord server or the months of gameplay and testing at the Wizard's Chest in Denver, Colorado.

QUESTIONS AND DOWNLOADS

The *BattleTech: Outworlds Wastes* GitHub repository is at https://github.com/Eudicods/outworlds-wastes. You can ask questions as Issues or download the latest *BattleTech: Outworlds Wastes* rules.

VERSION

This document is current as of March 7, 2024.

BACKGROUND

The Outworlds Alliance was founded in 2413 and enjoyed prosperity throughout the Star League Era. By the start of the Amaris Civil War in 2766, the Outworlds Alliance contained over 135 major systems across 7 administrative districts. The Succession Wars that followed the fall of the Star League in 2780 were particularly difficult for the Outworlds Alliance, and they had to steadily abandon systems that they no longer had the resources to support.

Clan Snow Raven began exploring the Periphery for resources soon after the battle of Tukayyid ended Operation REVIVAL. In 3064, Clan Snow Raven and the Outworlds Alliance began developing mutual respect and a tentative alliance. Following their abjuration from the Clan Homeworlds in 3075 after the Wars of Reaving, Clan Snow Raven took refuge in the Outworlds Alliance. In 3083, Clan Snow Raven and the Outworlds Alliance merged to form the Raven Alliance. By the ilClan Trial in 3151, the Raven Alliance contained only 47 systems.

The exact number of lost systems varies from era to era, but approximately 88 systems that were part of the Outworlds Alliance during the Star League era were abandoned. These lost worlds form the Outworlds Wastes. Many factions are eager to explore these lost worlds in search of lost Star League technology or to take refuge from the complex political machinations of the Inner Sphere.

You will take the role of commander of a combined arms force exploring the Outworlds Wastes for your faction during the current league era. Common factions for the region include

- Outworlds Alliance
- Clan Snow Raven
- Draconis Combine
- Federated Suns
- Mercenary groups
- Pirate gangs
- Clan Dark Caste

Commanders should pick the faction they are most interested in representing. While the common factions listed above are the most prevalent in the region, many other factions may be found in the Outworlds Wastes. For example, the Raven Alliance has relationships with nations on the far side of the Periphery, such as the Magistracy of Canopus.

Commanders will compete with other factions in the Outworlds Wastes to grow their force and recover lost technology. Scenarios are primarily designed for BattleTech, but scenarios for BattleTech: Alpha Strike and other formats are also supported.

League organizers pick the era for the current league; organizers can select any era after the fall of the Star League. The era determines unit availability and the most common factions in the Outworlds Wastes. Commanders should ask the league organizers which era is being used.

FORCE CONSTRUCTION

Commanders start with 3,000 BV to acquire initial units for their force. BV costs for all units are listed in the Master Unit List or MegaMekLab. Force construction must follow these rules:

- Commanders have a modified Leopard class dropship that can hold a maximum of 4 units. Your entire force must fit onto your dropship.
- Commanders should select units from one faction on the Master Unit List for the era chosen by event organizers. Forces can include units with introductory, standard, and advanced technology. Custom, experimental, and unique units are not permitted.
- Each force must have at least one 'Mech.
- Each force must have at least one infantry or Battle Armor unit.
- Each force must have one unit capable of carrying the infantry/Battle Armor unit. An OmniMech can carry standard Battle Armor with battle claws. Mechanized infantry units include vehicles to carry themselves.
- Forces cannot contain aerospace or battlefield support units, including on-map artillery.
- The BV costs of a unit includes all adjustments, to include skill levels, C^3, and TAG. Skill levels should generally be close to the average skill levels given on page 40 of *BattleTech: Total Warfare*. The skill levels for a unit may be no better than Gunnery 3/Piloting 4 and no worse than Gunnery 5/Piloting 6. ProtoMechs always have Piloting 5 and infantry units that cannot make anti-'Mech attacks have Anti-'Mech 5, because these skills are not used for these units.

Commanders must bring the rulebooks for any special equipment not found in *BattleTech: Total Warfare* or *BattleTech: BattleMech Manual*. Unit record sheets can be generated using MegaMekLab or similar tools.

BV costs sometimes do not mach between the Master Unit List and MegaMekLab, especially for conventional infantry units, due differences in the official rules. Commanders must use the same source for all BV costs. All record sheets must agree with the BV costs from this source.

Commanders may maintain and improve their force between scenarios with the Force Maintenance rules, page 5. An improved force cannot exceed 5,000 BV and must follow the other limitations given above. See the sample force tracking sheet on page 9. Alternatively, commanders may use a new force for each scenario.

Two sample initial forces are provided; the first force is an ilClan era mercenary unit and the second force is an ilClan era Raven Alliance detachment. Pilot names are encouraged, as one of the goals is to develop the personalized lore for your force.

Bay	Unit	Pilot	Gunnery	Piloting	BV	Adj BV
1	Archer ARC-7S	'Meg' Courant	3	5	1,658	1,990
2	Cavalry Attack (BA)	'Bugs' Schwann	3	5	604	725
3	IS Standard (Laser)	Ralph Nosske	3	5	231	277
	Total BV					2,992

ilClan Era Mercenary Force - Meg's Magpies

Bay	Unit	Pilot	Gunnery	Piloting	BV	Adj BV
1	Carrion Crow C	Sarah Magnus	3	4	1,826	2,410
2	Elemental BA [Laser]	Harry	3	4	447	590
	Total BV					3,000

ilClan Era Raven Alliance Force - Raven Expeditionary Cluster

FORCE MAINTENANCE

Commanders can spend C-bills they earn in scenarios to improve their force. Possible improvements are listed below. C-bill costs for all units are listed on the Master Unit List. The C-bill cost in MegaMekLab can be used if the Master Unit List does not list a cost.

- **Train**: Pay 500,000 C-bills multiplied by the difference in BV skill multiplier to improve a unit's skill levels. For example, a Gunnery 4/Piloting 5 pilot has a BV skill multiplier of 1.0 and a 3/4 pilot has a BV skill multiplier of 1.32. Therefore, it costs 160,000 C-bills to train a 4/5 pilot to be a 3/4 pilot. Units cannot be upgraded past 2/3. See *BattleTech: TechManual*, page 315, for the BV skill multiplier table. A unit's skill levels can be degraded at no C-bill cost. ProtoMechs and infantry units that cannot make anti-'Mech attacks have Piloting/Anti-'Mech 5.
- **Replace**: Pay 50% of the C-bill cost, rounded up, to replace a *destroyed* unit. If the 'Mech pilot or vehicle crew was killed, the replacement cost includes a 4/5 pilot or crew. If an entire infantry or Battle Armor unit was destroyed, the replacement cost includes 4/5 troops. The ProtoMech replacement cost includes a 4/5 pilot. The new unit can be trained as above. See *BattleTech: Total Warfare* for the definition of *destroyed* for different types of units.
- **Repair**: Pay 25% of the C-bill cost, rounded up, to repair all internal damage and critical components for a unit that has not been *destroyed*. If the pilot or crew was killed, the repair cost includes a 5/6 pilot or crew. Armor repairs have no C-bill cost.
- **Recruit**: Pay 50% of the C-bill cost, rounded up, recruit new troops to replace troops in an infantry or Battle Armor unit that has not been *destroyed*. For example, if 1 out of 4 troops was killed in a Battle Armor squad, pay 50% of the C-bill cost for 1 troop. To replace 1 troop in a squad of 4 IS Standard Battle Armor with Lasers, pay 293,125 C-bills. Damage to Battle Armor troops that survive a scenario is repaired for free.
- **Omni Refit**: OmniMechs can be temporarily configured as a cheaper variant for a scenario at no cost. For example, the Carrion Crow C is worth 10,336,492 C-bills. The Carrion Crow A only costs 9,704,829 C-bills, so a Carrion Crow C can be temporarily configured as a Carrion Crow A for a scenario.
- **Purchase**: Pay the C-bill cost to get a new unit. Commanders should purchase units from their Master Unit List faction and era list. The new unit includes a pilot/crew at skill 4/5 and can be trained.
- **Salvage**: Pay 50% the C-bill cost, rounded up, to salvage enemy units that that were destroyed in a scenario. A War Crow Prime costs 22,057,358 C-bills, and a salvaged War Crow Prime costs 11,028,679 C-bills. Salvage is the primary way to get units from a different Master Unit List faction list. The new unit starts at skill 4/5 and can be trained. Alternatively, commanders can earn 25% of the C-bill cost by selling a salvaged unit. A salvaged War Crow Prime could be sold to earn 5,514,340 C-bills instead of paying 11,028,679 C-bills to repair it.
- **Sell**: Commanders can sell units for 50% of the C-bill cost or destroyed units for 25% of the C-bill cost, rounded up. A Locust LCT-1E costs 1,574,200 C-bills and can be sold for 787,100 C-bills. If the Locust LCT-1E was destroyed, then selling it would only yield 393,550 C-bills.

If a commander is using units from a full *BattleTech: Outworlds Wastes* league list, they may apply all earned C-bills and maintenance costs from the event to their full list. However, only C-bills earned during the event may be used for force maintenance during the event.

EVENT SCENARIOS

Event organizers provide scenarios, which may be either player-vs-GM or player-vs-player. These scenarios award C-bills through completing objectives and receiving base pay. The C-bills awarded in a scenario will tend to follow these guidelines:

- **Base Pay**: Each force receives a base payment of 500,000 C-bills. This C-bill payment represents the baseline cost of a mercenary contract or supplies sent by a faction.
- **Objectives**: Forces earn C-bills for completing primary and secondary objectives. This C-bill payment represents bonus pay in a mercenary contract and the value of resources or technology acquired by completing mission objectives.
  - Each primary objective is worth no more than 2,000,000 C-bills and is awarded to every player on a side.
  - Each secondary objective is worth no more than 500,000 C-bills and is awarded to each player individually.

A scenario will have multiple primary and secondary objectives, with each player having the opportunity to earn approximately 5,000,000 C-bills from objectives.

A full list of primary and secondary objectives for each scenario will be provided by the event organizers. This list may change during each scenario as new objectives are revealed. A sample list of secondary objectives is provided here:

1. Cripple or destroy a ’Mech.
2. Cripple or destroy a ProtoMech.
3. Cripple or destroy a Combat Vehicle.
4. Cause critical or motive damage on a VTOL unit.
5. Kill at least half of the troops in an infantry unit.
6. Swarm a ’Mech or Combat Vehicle with an infantry unit.
7. Successfully complete a Death from Above attack.
8. Damage an internal section of an opponent’s highest BV unit.
9. Capture a vehicle crew or ’Mech pilot.

CASUAL PLAY

Event organizers may allow commanders to play additional casual scenarios between the official event scenarios. Event organizers will provide a packet of casual play scenarios for the event, if they are allowed.

Commanders use their entire force for a casual scenario. Commanders may temporarily modify the skill levels of their units to balance the BV of each side in a casual scenario. The BV or PV of each side should be within 10% of each other.

Each casual scenario will have a maximum of 5,000,000 C-bills in objectives payments. A commander can accept either all of the objectives pay and repair costs or none of the objectives pay and repair costs. Any objective pay from casual scenarios can be used to improve a force, so long as repair costs have been applied.

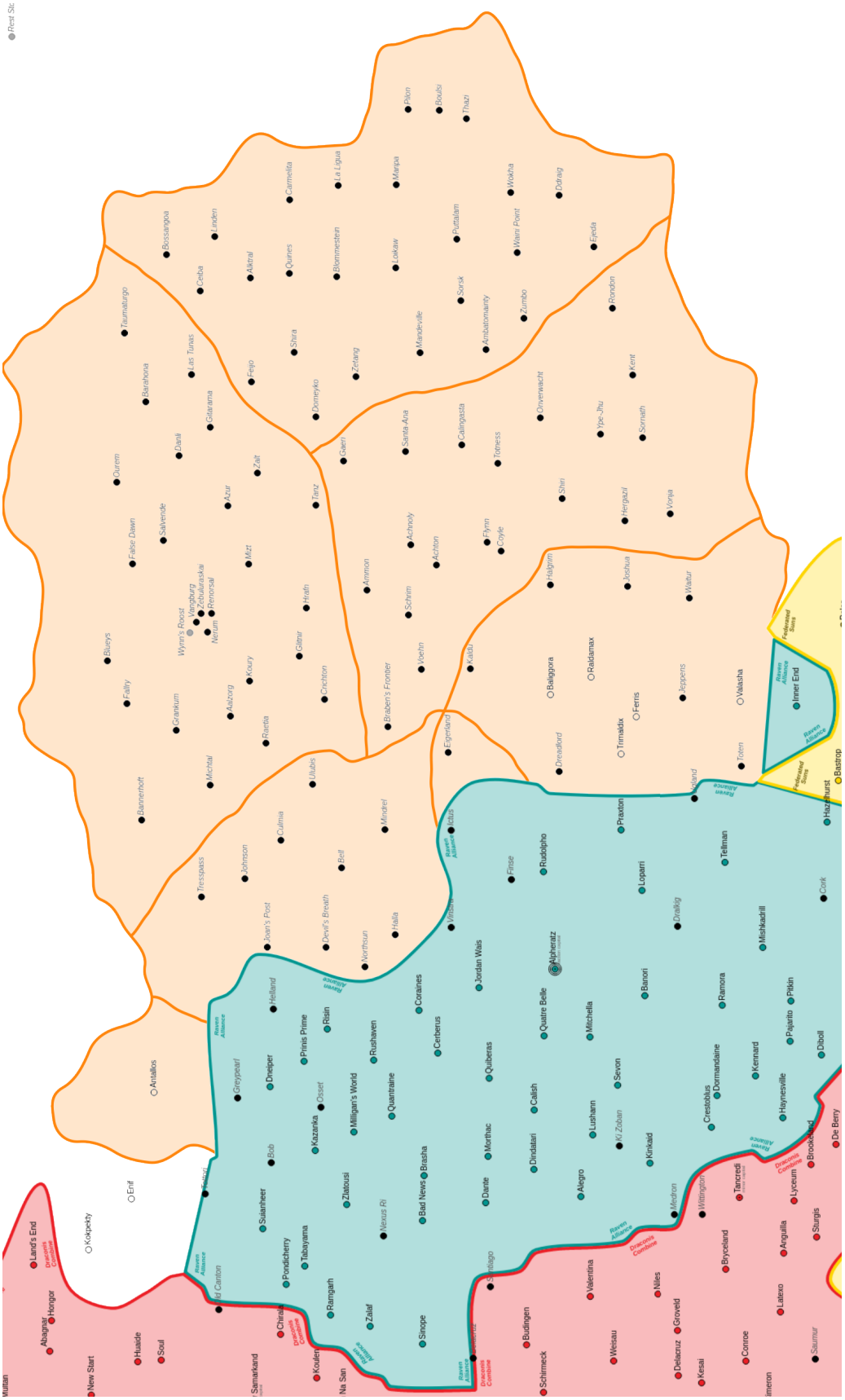
CONVERSION

Commanders can convert their force from an event into a full *BattleTech: Outworlds Wastes* force. All of the full Force Construction rules apply, with the following modifications.

- Units from the event that are damaged but not *destroyed* are repaired for free.
- Units from the event that are *destroyed* but not replaced cannot be added to the new force.
- Units from the event may keep any skill upgrades purchased during the event. Units from the event may also have their skill levels degraded, if desired.
- Commanders may change their faction as long as the units from the event are available on the new faction list. Commanders may use the *Advanced Force Construction* rules to create a custom faction list.
- Commanders may keep any C-bills earned during the event. If the force ended the event with fewer than 3,000,000 C-bills, then start with 3,000,000 C-bills.

If the event force came from an existing full *BattleTech: Outworlds Wastes* force, then the commander may apply any force improvements and objective pay earned during their event to their full force, but unit damage is not repaired for free in this case.

OUTWORLDS WASTES MAP - ILCLAN ERA



Outworlds Wastes - 3151

SAMPLE SCENARIO LOGISTICS TRACKING

Initial Force						
Bay	Unit	Pilot	Gunnery	Piloting	C-bills	BV
1						
2						
3						
4						
Total BV						
Force Management						
Starting C-bills						
Objectives						
Primary Objective Secondary Objective						
Training Pay 500,000 × BV skill multiplier difference, cannot exceed 2/3						
1						
2						
3						
4						
Maintenance (Replace, Repair, and Recruit) Pay 50% cost if destroyed, 25% cost to repair internal damage Pay 50% cost per troop killed						
1						
2						
3						
4						
Refits Pay cost difference to change variants						
1						
2						
Purchases Pay cost to add to TOE						
1						
2						
Sell Earn 50% cost						
1						
2						
Salvage Pay 50% cost to add to TOE or sell to earn 25% cost						
1						
2						
...						
Final C-bills						
Total C-bills						
Final Force						
Bay	Unit	Pilot	Gunnery	Piloting	C-bills	BV
1						
2						
3						
4						
Total BV (5,000 limit)						

FORCE BV ADJUSTMENTS

These adjustments, and all other applicable adjustments, are applied in order.

- Each unit equipped with TAG or a C^3 master computer adds BV for each ton of semi-guided LRM ammunition carried by all units in the force.
- Each unit that is part of a C^3 network increases its BV by 5% of the total BV of all units included in the C^3 network.
- Pilot/crew skill levels apply a multiplier to the unit BV.

Gunnery	**Piloting/Driving/Anti-'Mech**							
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
1	2.11	2.02	1.92	1.76	1.60	1.54	1.46	1.38
2	1.85	1.76	1.68	1.54	1.40	1.35	1.28	1.21
3	1.58	1.51	1.44	1.32	1.20	1.16	1.10	1.04
4	1.32	1.26	1.20	1.10	1.00	0.95	0.90	0.85
5	1.19	1.13	1.08	0.99	0.90	0.86	0.81	0.77
6	1.12	1.07	1.02	0.94	0.85	0.81	0.77	0.72
7	1.06	1.01	0.96	0.88	0.80	0.76	0.72	0.68
8	0.99	0.95	0.90	0.83	0.75	0.71	0.68	0.64

This summary is provided here for convenience. *BattleTech: TechManual* page 315 and all relevant errata, including the June 2021 Battle Value Errata, supersedes this information.

REFERENCES

The following references are mentioned in these rules:

- *BattleTech: Total Warfare*
- *BattleTech: BattleMech Manual*
- *BattleTech: TechManual*
- *BattleTech: Tactical Operations Advanced Rules*
- *BattleTech: Tactical Operations Advanced Units & Equipment*
- *BattleTech: Campaign Operations*
- *Alpha Strike: Commander's Edition*
- *Official Errata*: https://bg.battletech.com/errata
- *Official Downloads*: https://bg.battletech.com/downloads
- *Master Unit List*: http://www.masterunitlist.info
- *MegaMek*: https://megamek.org
- *Sarna.net*: https://sarna.net

These additional resources may also be helpful:

- *Flechs Sheets*: https://sheets.flechs.net
- *Jeff's BattleTech Tools*: https://jdgwf.github.io/battletech-tools
- *Mech Factory*: https://battletech.rpg.hu
- *Mordel.net*: https://mordel.net

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